Eating/Baking Fruit Tree Selection

Apples, Plums, Peaches, Pears, Cherries, Apricots, Persimmons

🍎 Apple Selection – 16 Trees

Zone 4 | Eating + Baking | Extended Harvest

State Fair – 2 Trees

https://rootstofruitsnursery.com/products/state-fair-apple

- **Price:** $51
- **Shipping Size:** 6–7′ bare-root
- **Rootstock:** *Seedling* (standard vigor, largest tree)
- **Mature Height:** ~16–22′
- **Harvest:** Early–Mid August
- **Bloom Group:** 3–4
- **Pollination:** Requires cross-pollination
- **Disease Notes:** Moderate susceptibility
- **Use:** Early fresh eating, applesauce
- **Why Included:** Earliest pick to open the season.

Zestar! – 3 Trees

watch: https://youtu.be/AT0lciFYdtw

buy: https://rootstofruitsnursery.com/products/zestar

- **Price:** $51
- **Shipping Size:** 6–7′ bare-root
- **Rootstock:** *M7* (semi-dwarf)
- **Mature Height:** ~14–18′
- **Harvest:** Late August – Early September
- **Bloom Group:** 3
- **Pollination:** Requires cross-pollination
- **Disease Notes:** Moderate scab susceptibility
- **Use:** Fresh eating, light baking
- **Why Included:** Reliable early Wisconsin apple with balanced flavor.

Honeycrisp – 3 Trees

https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=-Avep8mw2gk

https://rootstofruitsnursery.com/products/honeycrisp

- **Price:** $51
- **Shipping Size:** 6–7′ bare-root

- **Rootstock:** *M111* (semi-vigorous) OR *M7* (sometimes offered; check invoice)
- **Mature Height:** ~15–20′ (more vigorous if M111)
- **Harvest:** Mid-September
- **Bloom Group:** 4
- **Pollination:** Requires cross-pollination
- **Disease Notes:** Moderate resistance; some susceptibility to bitter pit
- **Use:** Premium fresh eating
- **Why Included:** Mid-season crowd favorite.

SnowSweet – 3 Trees

watch: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GPrkFwYU7qU
https://rootstofruitsnursery.com/products/snowsweet

- **Price:** $51
- **Shipping Size:** 6–7′ bare-root
- **Rootstock:** *M7* (semi-dwarf)
- **Mature Height:** ~14–18′
- **Harvest:** Late September – Early October
- **Bloom Group:** 4
- **Pollination:** Requires cross-pollination
- **Disease Notes:** Good scab/fire blight tolerance for apples
- **Use:** Fresh eating, salads, short storage
- **Why Included:** Very winter-friendly and dependable.

Cortland – 3 Trees

watch: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ElsQB1_kD8k
https://rootstofruitsnursery.com/products/cortland-apple

- **Price:** $51
- **Shipping Size:** 6–7′ bare-root
- **Rootstock:** *M7* (semi-dwarf)
- **Mature Height:** ~14–18′
- **Harvest:** Late September – October
- **Bloom Group:** 3–4
- **Pollination:** Requires cross-pollination
- **Disease Notes:** Moderate scab susceptibility; good juice/texture retention
- **Use:** Pies, crisps, sauces, fresh eating
- **Why Included:** Core baking apple with storied performance.

Haralson – 2 Trees

https://rootstofruitsnursery.com/products/haralson-apple

- **Price:** $51
- **Shipping Size:** 6–7′ bare-root
- **Rootstock:** *M7* (semi-dwarf)
- **Mature Height:** ~15–20′
- **Harvest:** Mid–Late October
- **Bloom Group:** 3–4
- **Pollination:** Requires cross-pollination
- **Disease Notes:** Good rust & scab resistance; hardy
- **Use:** Baking, storage
- **Why Included:** Extends harvest deep into fall.

Rootstock Notes Explained

Rootstocks listed are from Roots to Fruits Nursery where shown:

Rootstock	Vigor	Approx. Mature Height
Seedling	Standard	~16–22′+
M7	Semi-Dwarf	~12–18′
M111	Semi-Vigorous	~15–20′

Your trees will be **manageable orchard size** without turning into full standards. For home orchards, **M7** gives good productivity and easier pruning/ladders. **Seedling** trees are larger and take longer to mature but produce solid yields.

Bloom & Pollination Coverage

Variety	Bloom Group
State Fair	3–4
Zestar!	3
Honeycrisp	4
SnowSweet	4
Cortland	3–4
Haralson	3–4

All overlap within **Group 3–4**, which gives excellent cross-pollination without requiring external pollinators. Good redundancy if one variety has a light bloom year.

Disease Resistance Considerations

- **Best overall resistance: SnowSweet** (above-average tolerance to scab/fire blight)
- **Strong hardy performer: Haralson** (good rust & scab resistance)
- **Moderate resistance: Honeycrisp, Zestar!, Cortland, State Fair** — these benefit from good airflow and sanitation (pruning, leaf litter cleanup) but produce quality fruit in Wisconsin with attentive management.

Orchard Layout Implications

With semi-dwarf rootstocks (mostly **M7**), expect:

- **Tree spacing:** 14–16 ft within rows
- **Row spacing:** 18–22 ft
- **Mature canopy width:** ~12–15 ft
- **Reachable fruit height:** ~14–20 ft (manageable ladders)

If any shipments arrive on **standard seedling rootstock (State Fair)**, those trees will be taller and require longer ladders and spacing.

Harvest Sequence (Wisconsin)

Early August
→ *State Fair*
Late August – Early September
→ *Zestar!*
Mid-September
→ *Honeycrisp*
Late September – Early October
→ *SnowSweet*
→ *Cortland*
Mid-Late October
→ *Haralson*

This gives roughly **10–11 weeks of picking** with minimal overlap gaps.

🍐 Pears - Select 6 Trees

Summercrisp Pear

https://rootstofruitsnursery.com/products/summercrisp-pear

- **Price (6–7′ largest bare root):** ~$79–$99
- **Bare Root Size:** ~6–7 ft whips
- **Mature Height:** ~15–20 ft
- **USDA Hardiness:** Zones **3–7** (excellent cold tolerance)
- **Bloom:** Spring
- **Pollination: Needs cross-pollination**
- **Taste & Usage:** Very **crisp and juicy**, sweet with good flavor right off the tree, **fresh eating**, also good for salads and snacking.
- **Notes:** One of the best cold-climate pears for flavor and texture.

Patten Pear

https://rootstofruitsnursery.com/products/patten-pear

- **Price (6–7′ largest bare root):** ~$79–$99
- **Bare Root Size:** ~6–7 ft
- **Mature Height:** ~15–20 ft
- **USDA Hardiness:** Zones **3–7**
- **Bloom:** Spring
- **Pollination: Needs cross-pollination**
- **Taste & Usage:** Sweet, **full flavor**, juicy with a bit of firmness; **fresh eating** and good for **canning or baking**.
- **Notes:** Excellent northern cultivar with reliable crops.

Parker Pear

https://rootstofruitsnursery.com/products/parker-pear

- **Price (6–7′ largest bare root):** ~$79–$99
- **Bare Root Size:** ~6–7 ft
- **Mature Height:** ~15–20 ft
- **USDA Hardiness:** Zones **3–7**
- **Bloom:** Spring
- **Pollination: Needs cross-pollination**
- **Taste & Usage:** Tender, sweet, pleasant acidity; **fresh eating**, also fine for **desserts and light cooking**.
- **Notes:** Good upper-Midwest performer.

Harrow Pear

https://rootstofruitsnursery.com/products/harrow-pear

- **Price (6–7′ largest bare root):** ~$79–$99
- **Bare Root Size:** ~6–7 ft whip
- **Mature Height:** ~15–20 ft
- **USDA Hardiness:** Zones **3–7**
- **Bloom:** Spring
- **Pollination: Needs cross-pollination**
- **Taste & Usage:** Sweet, crisp with good aroma; **fresh eating** and **light cooking**.
- **Notes:** Another cold-hardy heirloom selection.

Moonglow Pear

https://rootstofruitsnursery.com/products/moonglow-pear

- **Price (6–7′ largest bare root):** ~$79–$99
- **Bare Root Size:** ~6–7 ft
- **Mature Height:** ~15–20 ft
- **USDA Hardiness:** Zones **4–8**
- **Bloom:** Spring
- **Pollination: Needs cross-pollination**
- **Taste & Usage:** Juicy, sweet, fine texture; **fresh eating**, **canning** and **dessert** pear.
- **Notes:** Slightly less winter hardy than others but still Zone 4/5 appropriate.

Seckel Pear

https://rootstofruitsnursery.com/products/seckel-pear

- **Price (6–7′ largest bare root):** ~$79–$99
- **Bare Root Size:** ~6–7 ft
- **Mature Height:** ~12–18 ft (more compact)
- **USDA Hardiness:** Zones **4–8**
- **Bloom:** Spring
- **Pollination: Needs cross-pollination**
- **Taste & Usage:** Very **sweet and flavorful** (often called sugar pear); excellent **fresh eating**, also great for **desserts**.
- **Notes:** Classic small pear with intense flavor.

Ure Pear

https://rootstofruitsnursery.com/products/ure-pear

- **Price (6–7′ largest bare root):** ~$79–$99
- **Bare Root Size:** ~6–7 ft
- **Mature Height:** ~15–20 ft
- **USDA Hardiness:** Zones **3–7**
- **Bloom:** Spring
- **Pollination: Needs cross-pollination**
- **Taste & Usage:** Mildly sweet, firm texture; **fresh eating**, good for **cooking/sauces**.
- **Notes:** Proven northern cultivar.

Additional Wisconsin Orchard Notes

Pollination Strategy

None of these pears are self-fertile. For good fruit set, plant **at least two different varieties** that bloom at overlapping times. Your list (Summercrisp, Patten, Parker) already forms a strong pollination set. Adding Seckel or Harrow can further stabilize pollination across bloom.

Bloom & Frost Risk

Pear blooms are typically **early to mid-spring**, which means a slightly higher frost risk than later-blooming plums. Good orchard site planning (slope, shelterbelts, frost drainage) helps reduce this risk.

Taste & Use Grouping

- **Best for fresh eating:** Summercrisp, Seckel, Moonglow
- **Fresh + versatile (cooking/canning):** Patten, Ure, Harrow
- **Balanced sweet flavor:** Parker

Mature Size & Spacing

Standard pear trees commonly reach **15–20 ft tall and wide** in orchard settings. Typical orchard spacing is **18–22 ft between trees** and **20–24 ft between rows** unless you're planting on semi-dwarf rootstock.

🟣 Plums - Select 6 trees

Toka Plum

https://rootstofruitsnursery.com/products/toka

- **Price:** ~$89–$99 (bare root)
- **Bare Root Size:** 5–6 ft whip (typical listing)
- **Type:** Japanese/American hybrid
- **USDA Zone:** 3–9 (very winter hardy)
- **Mature Height:** 12–15 ft (on Myrobalan dwarf/semi-dwarf)
- **Fruit:** Medium red fruit, very sweet, juicy, freestone
- **Ripens:** Late August–early September
- **Bloom:** Mid-spring
- **Pollination:** Self-fertile but also an excellent pollinator for other hybrid plums
- **Notes for WI:** Extremely reliable cold performer. Good anchor tree for hybrid group.

Black Ice® Plum

https://rootstofruitsnursery.com/products/black-ice

- **Price:** ~$99–$109 (bare root)
- **Bare Root Size:** 5–6 ft whip
- **Type:** Japanese hybrid (Wisconsin-adapted)
- **USDA Zone:** 3–9
- **Mature Height:** 10–15 ft (naturally compact habit)
- **Fruit:** Dark purple skin, deep red flesh, very sweet, freestone
- **Ripens:** Late July–early August (early season)
- **Bloom:** Spring, slightly earlier than European types
- **Pollination:** Requires pollinator (Toka or Superior work well)
- **Notes for WI:** Very cold hardy but blooms a bit earlier, so frost pockets matter.

Stanley European Plum

https://rootstofruitsnursery.com/products/stanley-plum

- **Price:** ~$89–$99 (bare root)
- **Bare Root Size:** 5–6 ft whip
- **Type:** European (*Prunus domestica*)
- **USDA Zone:** 4–8 (borderline but proven in WI)
- **Mature Height:** 12–15 ft (can reach 18 ft on vigorous rootstock)
- **Fruit:** Blue skin, yellow flesh, classic prune plum

- **Ripens:** Early–mid September
- **Bloom:** Later blooming than hybrids
- **Pollination:** Self-fertile
- **Notes for WI:** Later bloom = safer from frost. Very dependable.

Superior Plum

(Usually stocked at WI nurseries; example listing)
https://www.gurneys.com/products/superior_plum_tree

- **Price:** ~$89–$109 bare root (varies by nursery)
- **Bare Root Size:** 4–5 ft whip typical
- **Type:** Japanese/American hybrid
- **USDA Zone:** 4–8
- **Mature Height:** 12–15 ft, spreading form
- **Fruit:** Large red fruit, sweet yellow flesh
- **Ripens:** Mid–late August
- **Bloom:** Mid-spring
- **Pollination:** Needs pollinator (Toka or Black Ice)
- **Notes for WI:** Productive, cold hardy, strong hybrid option.

Mount Royal European Plum

https://raintreenursery.com/products/mount-royal-e-plum-semi-dwarf

- **Price:** ~$49–$69 bare root (varies by supplier)
- **Bare Root Size:** 4–5 ft typical
- **Type:** European
- **USDA Zone:** 4–7 (very hardy European type)
- **Mature Height:** 12–16 ft (semi-vigorous)
- **Fruit:** Blue skin, yellow flesh, sweet, freestone
- **Ripens:** Mid–late August
- **Bloom:** Later bloom
- **Pollination:** Self-fertile
- **Notes for WI:** One of the hardiest European plums. Strong choice for northern orchards.

Valor European Plum

https://fedcoseeds.com/trees/valor-european-plum-7418

- **Price:** ~$49–$59 bare root (varies)
- **Bare Root Size:** 4–5 ft typical
- **Type:** European
- **USDA Zone:** 4–8
- **Mature Height:** 15–18 ft (more vigorous than Stanley)

- **Fruit:** Large dark purple plum, high dessert quality
- **Ripens:** Late September (later than Stanley)
- **Bloom:** Late spring
- **Pollination:** Benefits from another European plum
- **Notes for WI:** Later ripening. Needs good season length. Might be pushing it in far northern WI.

Quick Orchard Strategy for Wisconsin

You really have two groups here:

Hybrid/Japanese Group (earlier, very cold hardy):

Toka, Black Ice, Superior

European Group (later bloom, later harvest):

Stanley, Mount Royal, Valor

They do not reliably cross-pollinate between groups.

If this were my Wisconsin orchard, I'd likely:

- Anchor hybrids with **Toka + Black Ice**
- Anchor Europeans with **Stanley + Mount Royal**
- Add Valor only if you want a later, high-quality dessert plum and your growing season supports it.

🍑 Peach - 6 Trees (Hardy Zone 4)

Contender Peach

https://rootstofruitsnursery.com/products/contender-peach

- **Price:** $51 (6–7′ bare-root)
- **Shipping Size:** 6–7′ bare-root whip
- **Mature Height:** 12–15 ft
- **USDA Hardiness: Zone 4–8**
- **Ripens:** Mid–late August
- **Pollination:** Self-fertile
- **Taste Profile:** Sweet, juicy, classic yellow freestone
- **Usage:** Excellent **fresh eating**, strong for **canning and baking**
- **Why It Stays:** Later bloom + excellent cold bud survival. One of the safest bets in cold climates.

Intrepid Peach

https://rootstofruitsnursery.com/products/intrepid-peach

- **Price:** $51 (6–7′ bare-root)
- **Shipping Size:** 6–7′ bare-root
- **Mature Height:** 10–15 ft
- **USDA Hardiness: Zone 4–7**
- **Ripens:** Early–mid August
- **Pollination:** Self-fertile
- **Taste Profile:** Firm, balanced sweetness, freestone
- **Usage:** Great for **fresh eating**, very good for **canning**
- **Why It Stays:** Noted for late bloom and strong frost resistance. Extremely valuable in volatile springs.

Reliance Peach

https://www.starkbros.com/products/fruit-trees/peach-trees/reliance-peach

- **Shipping Size (Stark Bros):** Semi-Dwarf, bare-root, **3–4′ tall, 3/8″ trunk**
- **Mature Height:** 12–15 ft
- **USDA Hardiness: Zone 4–8**
- **Ripens:** Early July
- **Pollination:** Self-fertile
- **Taste Profile:** Sweet, juicy, softer texture, freestone
- **Usage:** Excellent for **fresh eating and preserving**
- **Why It Stays:** Probably the most historically proven cold-hardy peach for northern growers.

Blushingstar Peach

https://www.starkbros.com/products/fruit-trees/peach-trees/blushingstar-peach

- **Shipping Size:** Semi-Dwarf, bare-root, **3–4′ tall, 3/8″ trunk**
- **Mature Height:** 10–12 ft
- **USDA Hardiness: Zone 4–8**
- **Ripens:** Mid-August
- **Pollination:** Self-fertile
- **Taste Profile:** Sweet, aromatic white flesh, low acidity
- **Usage:** Excellent **fresh eating**, salads, desserts
- **Why It Stays:** Good cold tolerance plus high eating quality.

Bounty Peach

https://www.starkbros.com/products/fruit-trees/peach-trees/bounty-peach

- **Shipping Size:** Semi-Dwarf, bare-root, **3–4′ tall, 3/8″ trunk**
- **Mature Height:** 10–15 ft
- **USDA Hardiness: Zone 4–8**
- **Ripens:** Late August
- **Pollination:** Self-fertile
- **Taste Profile:** Sweet, juicy yellow freestone
- **Usage:** Good all-purpose peach, fresh or processed
- **Why It Stays:** Solid cold tolerance and reliable productivity.

🍒 SWEET CHERRY VARIETIES - Select 6 Trees — WI COLD CLIMATE FOCUS

Lapins Sweet Cherry - 3 Trees

https://rootstofruitsnursery.com/collections/sweet-cherry-trees/zone_4

- **Price: $51** (6–7′ bare-root)
- **Mature Height:** ~15–18 ft
- **USDA Hardiness: Zones 4–8** (among the hardiest sweet cherries)
- **Harvest Window: Late July – Early August**
- **Pollination Type: Self-fertile** (does not require a pollinator)
- **Taste Profile:** Large, firm, rich sweet cherries
- **Usage:** Excellent **fresh eating**, good for **baking and freezing**
- **Notes:** Very strong choice for Wisconsin because it sets fruit without a partner and has better cold tolerance than most sweet cherries.

Kristin Sweet Cherry - 3 Trees

https://rootstofruitsnursery.com/products/kristen-cherry

- **Price: $51** (6–7′ bare-root)
- **Mature Height:** ~17–21 ft
- **USDA Hardiness: Zones 4–8**
- **Harvest Window: Mid-July – Late July**
- **Pollination Type: Self-sterile** (needs a pollinator)
- **Best Pollinator Partner:** *Lapins*
- **Taste Profile:** Large, juicy, sweet with good flavor depth
- **Usage:** Excellent **fresh eating**, **desserts**, **preserves**
- **Notes:** Very good cold tolerance and high fruit quality. Pairs well with Lapins for reliable fruit set.

Rainier Sweet Cherry — Semi-Dwarf - Optional variety

https://www.starkbros.com/products/fruit-trees/cherry-trees/rainier-sweet-cherry

- **Price (estimated retail for 6–7′ equivalent):** ~$40–$60
- **Shipping Size:** Semi-Dwarf, bare-root ~3–4′ tall, ~3/8″ trunk
- **Mature Height:** ~15–20 ft
- **USDA Hardiness: Zones 5–8** (less cold tolerant than Lapins/Kristin)
- **Harvest Window: Late June – Early July**
- **Pollination Type: Self-sterile** (needs a pollinator)
- **Best Pollinator Partner:** *Lapins* or *Kristin*

- **Taste Profile:** Yellow-red fruit with bright, sweet flavor
- **Usage:** Outstanding **fresh eating**, also good for **desserts and freezing**
- **Notes:** Premium flavor but more frost/cold sensitive — best in protected microclimates or warmer parts of WI.

HARVEST CALENDAR — SWEET CHERRIES (WI)

Variety	Typical Harvest	Notes
Rainier	**Late June – Early July**	Earliest ripening; premium fruit
Kristin	**Mid-July – Late July**	Great mid-season
Lapins	**Late July – Early August**	Later fruiting with very good cold hardiness

This gives you a **nice sweet cherry harvest spread** from early summer into early August.

POLLINATION SUMMARY

Variety	Pollination	Compatible Partner
Lapins	**Self-fertile**	Can pollinate others
Kristin	Self-sterile	**Lapins** recommended
Rainier	Self-sterile	**Lapins** or **Kristin**

Key Orchard Rule:

- *Lapins* can fruit on its own — useful anchor tree.
- *Kristin* and *Rainier* must have a **sweet cherry pollination partner** with overlapping bloom.

COLD-CLIMATE REALITY — WISCONSIN ORCHARDS

Winter Hardiness:

- Sweet cherries overall are less hardy than tart cherries or apples.
- *Lapins* and *Kristin* are among the more cold-tolerant sweet cherries rated for **Zone 4**, which aligns with most of Wisconsin's fruit-growing regions.
- *Rainier* is rated for **Zone 5+**, meaning it's **less reliable in the coldest sites** — plant it in a warmer, protected microclimate if used.

Frost & Bloom Management:

- Sweet cherries bloom early, so blossoms can be damaged by late spring frosts.
- Site selection (southern exposure, frost drainage, windbreaks) directly impacts crop reliability.

ORCHARD STRATEGY — RECOMMENDED

Core Planting for Cold & Pollination

1. **Lapins Sweet Cherry** (self-fertile anchor, hardy, reliable)
2. **Kristin Sweet Cherry** (excellent quality, good cold tolerance, pollinates well with Lapins)

Together, this pairing provides:

- bloom overlap for solid pollination,
- a long harvest window,
- strong fruit set in colder climates.

Add for Premium Flavor Variety

- **Rainier Sweet Cherry** if you have:
- a **warm microclimate**, or
- protective frost management (site choice, windbreaks), coupled with **Lapins** close by for pollination.

TASTE & USAGE PROFILE

Variety	Flavor	Best Uses
Lapins	Rich and sweet	Fresh eating, baking, freezing
Kristin	Juicy, flavorful	Fresh, desserts,
Rainier	Bright, sweet, aromatic	Fresh eating, desserts, freezing

CLIENT SUMMARY

For a **cold-climate Wisconsin orchard**, based on hardiness, harvest timing, pollination, and fruit quality:

- **Primary Planting (Highly Recommended):** *Lapins* and *Kristin* sweet cherries
- These offer the best combination of cold tolerance and dependable fruit set.
- **Optional Addition:** *Rainier*
- Adds early harvest and distinctive flavor but requires good microclimate conditions.

Together, this suite of sweet cherries extends your harvest from **late June through early August** with excellent table quality and reasonable winter survival expectations.

🍑 Apricots - 2 Trees

Mormon Apricot

https://rootstofruitsnursery.com/products/copy-of-madison-peach

- **Price:** $55 — Hand-Select Bare Root, ships 6–7′ tall
- **Shipping Size:** 6–7′ bare-root
- **Rootstock:** Dwarf seedling, smaller than standard, spreading growth habit
- **Mature Height:** ~10–15′, typically maintained under ~12′ with pruning
- **USDA Hardiness:** Zones 4–7, suitable for Wisconsin with proper siting
- **Harvest Window:** Mid July
- **Bloom:** Later than many apricots, helps reduce frost risk
- **Pollination Type:** Mostly semi-self-fertile, will produce alone, better fruit set with 2+ trees
- **Fruit Characteristics:** Small to medium orange fruit, sweet juicy flesh, smooth texture, rosy blush
- **Primary Uses:** Fresh eating, canning, drying, jams, baking
- **Orchard Notes:** Precocious bearing, medium spreading habit, requires full sun and well-drained soil
- **Disease & Climate Notes:** Frost during bloom is main risk, susceptible to canker fruit rot and shot hole, good airflow and dormant copper sprays recommended

🍑 Persimmons - 6 Trees

(6 Trees to get best chance of male and female)

Meader Persimmon

https://www.starkbros.com/products/fruit-trees/persimmon-trees/meader-american-persimmon

- **Price (estimated retail for 6–7′ equivalent):** ~$40–$60
- **Shipping Size:** Semi-Dwarf / Bare-root, typically ~3–4′ tall with ~3/8″ trunk (depending on nursery)
- **Mature Height:** Very large tree if unmanaged, typically **30–60 ft** (pruneable for size)
- **USDA Hardiness: Zones 4–8** — among the most cold-tolerant American persimmons
- **Harvest Timing: October – November** (deep fall)
- **Pollination Type: Mostly self-fertile**, but fruit size/yield improve if other persimmons are nearby
- **Taste & Usage:** Sweet, rich orange fruit once soft; excellent for **fresh eating, baking, drying, and preserves**
- **Notes:** A classic northern persimmon selection with larger fruit and good cold survival.

Prairie Star® American Persimmon

https://onegreenworld.com/product/prairie-star-american-persimmon

- **Price:** ~$49–$69 (2–4′ bare-root typical; prices vary by nursery)
- **Shipping Size:** ~2–4′ bare-root whip
- **Mature Height:** ~12–20 ft (manageable with pruning)
- **USDA Hardiness: Zones 4–9** — reliable in cold climates
- **Harvest Timing: Late September – October**
- **Pollination Type: Self-fertile** (fruit sets on a single tree, but nearby persimmons can boost yield)
- **Taste & Usage:** Sweet, smooth fruit; great for **fresh eating, desserts, drying, and preserves**
- **Notes:** One of the most dependable cold-climate American persimmons; excellent choice for Wisconsin blocks.

Prairie Dawn® American Persimmon

https://onegreenworld.com/product/prairie-dawn-american-persimmon

- **Price:** ~$49–$69 (2–4′ bare-root typical; prices vary by nursery)
- **Shipping Size:** ~2–4′ bare-root whip

- **Mature Height:** ~12–20 ft (pruneable)
- **USDA Hardiness: Zones 4–9** — cold hardy for WI conditions
- **Harvest Timing: Late September – October** (often a bit earlier than many others)
- **Pollination Type: Self-fertile**
- **Taste & Usage:** Sweet, flavorful fruit; excellent for **fresh eating, cooking, and drying**
- **Notes:** Often one of the earlier-ripening American persimmons, spreading your harvest window.

Persimmon Pollination & Orchard Planning

Self-Fertility:

- *Prairie Star*® and *Prairie Dawn*® are considered **self-fertile** — they will set fruit on a single tree.
- *Meader* is also effectively self-fruitful, but having other persimmons nearby generally improves yield and fruit size.

Why Plant 4–6 Trees in the Block:

- American persimmons do not reliably express *male/female identity* before flowering. Planting **4–6 trees** of diverse cultivars increases the chance of having compatible biology that enhances pollination and yields, even if all seem self-fertile.
- A mix also extends the **harvest timing** and flavor offerings.

Harvest Window (Wisconsin)

Variety	Harvest Timing
Prairie Dawn®	**Late September – Early October**
Prairie Star®	**Late September – October**
Meader	**October – November**

This gives a **staggered fall harvest** from early autumn into deep fall.

Flavor & Usage Summary

Variety	Flavor Profile	Best Uses
Meader	Rich, sweet, custard-like when soft	Fresh eating, baking, drying, preserves
Prairie Star®	Sweet, smooth	Fresh eating, desserts, drying
Prairie Dawn®	Sweet, flavorful	Fresh eating, cooking, drying

Recommended Orchard Strategy — Wisconsin

For the best combination of **cold hardiness, harvest spread, yield reliability, and flavor variety**, consider a block like:

- 2 × **Prairie Dawn® American Persimmon**
- 2 × **Prairie Star® American Persimmon**
- 1–2 × **Meader Persimmon**

This block structure gives:

- Multiple cultivars for good genetic diversity (helpful for pollination and fruit set)
- A harvest window that spans **late September through November**
- Flavor variety and processing flexibility (fresh, dried, baked, preserves)

Spacing & Site Tips:

- Persimmons perform best in **full sun** with **good air drainage**.
- Soil should be **well-drained**; avoid wet feet over winter.
- Position trees where fall sun can help with fruit ripening and softening.